

his trading instructions. I thought it odd that the conference room was about five times larger than might ever be needed, whereas the trading room was cramped. John Apperson, a managing director at Centennial Partners and an investor in Banyan who had brought Benedict to my attention, explained this oddity in a phone conversation several months later. “A number of years ago when Banyan expanded their operation a bit with the growth of assets, they were all jammed together in that little room you saw. They decided to build out a new trading room in a larger space. The first day after they had relocated, Larry had a bad trading day. He said, ‘That’s it. Rip it out. We are moving back.’ What would appear to most of us as a much less comfortable work environment is not that way for Larry. Maybe he is more comfortable there because he can reach all his employees.”

Benedict is a happily transplanted New Yorker who lives in Florida with his wife, Lisa, and three sons. He loves the casual Florida lifestyle and dresses the part. Even though Benedict had institutional investors visiting his offices the day I interviewed him, he was wearing shorts and a T-shirt (maybe they were his dress shorts). Although the room was surprisingly chilly (and I’m someone who likes air conditioning set to cold temperatures), Benedict, who was more appropriately dressed for a heat wave, seemed perfectly comfortable.

Benedict was downright jovial in our conversation, but he was surprisingly candid about making me aware of the darker side of his temperament. In the course of our interview, Benedict enlisted several witnesses, both in person and by phone, to testify to his predilection to anger outbursts—a character trait I would not have guessed he had without his assistance. I later learned that his staff stocks ample inventories of phones, cell phones, and especially keyboards—items that are particularly vulnerable targets of Benedict’s periodic temper flares.



How would you describe your trading approach?

I am probably different from any of the other traders you’ll interview. If you come into my office, you’ll see that I don’t look at charts at all during the trading day. I am just tape reading.

And you don’t use fundamentals either?